Days had passed since his last attempt to capture Samarkand.

One day in late autumn, Babur along with Dost-i-Nasir, Nyyan Kukuldash, Khān Quli-i-Karim, Shaikh Darvesh, Mirim-i-Nasir and other household parties were sitting in the Fort Asfidik discussing Samarkand.

Babur said, ‘Come now! Say when, if Allah brings it right, we shall take Samarkand.’

Someone from among those attending the meeting replied, ‘We shall take it in the summers.’

Some said, ‘Forty days.’ Others said, ‘Twenty days’ and a few others said, ‘A month.’

While each was shouting to claim the most appropriate time to attack Samarkand, Nuyan Kukuldash said, ‘We shall take it in fourteen days.’ [*]

Babur claimed that perhaps Allah had shown him the right vision, as they took Samarkand exactly in fourteen days.

Babur has written in the *Baburnama* that it was then that he got trapped in dreams, and he saw His Highness Khwaja Ubaid’l-lah. He has described the dream as follows:[†]

> Babur goes to meet him and seated himself nearby. People were laying a tablecloth before him and something seemed to come into his Highness Khwaja’s mind. Mulla Baba (Pashdghari) signaled about the improper laying of Tablecloth and Babur too replied in sign language expressing an apology. The Khwaja understood and accepted the excuse. And when he rose, Babur escorted him out. While they were in antechamber, he took hold of Babur’s arms and lifted him till his feet were off the ground and said in Turki, ‘Shaikh Maslahat has given Samarkand.’

Though this was merely a dream, Babur indeed took over Samarkand in a few days to come (two weeks).

Babur Barges into Samarkand

In a couple of days, Babur along with his men made a move from Fort Asfidik to Fort Wasmand. Although during the first approach, there were loose ends that had let their plan be known, this time they put their trust in Allah and made another expedition to Samarkand. It was after the mid-day prayer that they rode out of Fort Wasmand, with Khwaja Abu’l-Makaram accompanying them. By midnight, they had reached a deep-fosse bridge in an avenue.

From there, Babur sent forward a detachment of eighty people to set up ladders opposite the Lovers’ Cave. They had clear instructions to mount them and get inside, stand up to those in the Turquoise Gate, get possession of it, and send a man to Babur carrying the information. As per the plan, those warriors of